Yueteng (Laurence) Yu

PhD Candidate at QUT | Advanced HMI Design for Automated Vehicles
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PROFILE

I am motivated by a simple question: how can automated driving become safe, understandable and genuinely comfortable for the people who will share the road with it?
I am a PhD candidate at CARRS-Q, Queensland University of Technology, researching advanced human-machine interfaces for automated vehicles.
My work focuses on multimodal HMI, driver engagement, situation awareness, passive fatigue, perceived safety and user experience in Level 3+ automated driving.

EXPERIENCE

Mar 2024 - Present - Research Associate (PhD), QUT Design Academy. Participates in interdisciplinary academic research activities on automotive UX and assists with Design Lab event coordination.
Feb 2024 - Present - PhD Candidate, AVR3 / CARRS-Q, Queensland University of Technology. Organises and designs test-track studies with a real autonomous vehicle, integrates multimodal systems for safety cue evaluation, and serves as Web Co-chair of AutoUI 2025.
Oct 2023 - Jan 2024 - HMI UX Researcher, CapsuleTech. Participated in BAIC off-road vehicle, Mercedes-Benz and Volvo HMI design consultancy projects as a user researcher.
Oct 2022 - Oct 2023 - Human-Computer Interaction Researcher, Tsinghua University. Worked with the HCI Research Group, Intelligent Transportation Lab, DISCOVER Lab and Institute of Intelligent Industry on L4 automated-vehicle road experiments, enterprise projects and national funding projects.
Jul 2021 - Software Engineer Associate, PwC Shanghai Acceleration Center. Received Tier 1 performance feedback, joined the Future Talent Program and worked on web-based and cloud-based B2B projects with a focus on Node.js.
Jul 2020 - Jun 2021 - Junior Software Engineer Specialist, PwC Shanghai Acceleration Center. Delivered Azure-based web applications and Power BI dashboards with Node.js, React.js and PostgreSQL; drove M&A requirement analysis and global teamwork; contributed to six compliance projects and more than ten deployments.
Jul 2019 - Jun 2020 - Junior Software Engineer Intern, PwC Shanghai Acceleration Center. Completed internship and received PwC Advisory Shanghai AC FY20 Internship Orientation Best Individual.
Jul 2017 - Sep 2017 - Software Development Intern, Guangzhou Innovision Marketing Co., Ltd. (Shanghai Branch). Worked on Java software development for revenue recognition and cost confirmation in a car advertising company context.

EDUCATION

Feb 2024 - Feb 2028 - Doctor of Philosophy, Queensland University of Technology. Human-Machine Interface research for automated vehicles.
Jul 2021 - Dec 2022 - MSc in Human-Computer Interaction, University of Nottingham. Graduated with Distinction; GPA 4.0.
Jan 2019 - Feb 2019 - Visiting Study, University of Canterbury. Cultural workshop and innovation training; ranked #1 in the visiting study cohort.
Sep 2016 - Jul 2020 - BEng in Software Engineering, Sanda University. GPA 3.81/4.0; ranked #1 in the software engineering course.

SELECTED RESEARCH OUTPUTS

2026 - Small Talk, Big Impact? LLM-based Conversational Agents to Mitigate Passive Fatigue in Conditional Automated Driving. ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems / arXiv:2510.25421. A test-track study with 40 participants exploring how an LLM-based conversational agent can support vigilance during passive fatigue in conditional automated driving.
2026 - An EEG Dataset for Understanding Driving Expertise from Naturalistic Urban Road Experiments. Scientific Data. A naturalistic urban road dataset for understanding driving expertise, connected with multimodal real-road driving behaviour research.
2025 - Designing With Motion: Exploring Vestibular Cues as a Subtle Awareness Nudge Modality in Automated Vehicles. AutomotiveUI 2025 Main Proceedings. A qualitative test-track study of vestibular cues, implemented through subtle deceleration events, as a dynamic HMI for nudging attention during Level 3 automated driving.